

Basics of Prompt Engineering

Prompt engineering is the skill of writing effective instructions (prompts) to get accurate, relevant, and useful responses from AI language models like ChatGPT.

1. What is a Prompt?

A prompt is the input you give to an AI model. It can be a question, instruction, statement, or example that guides the model's response.

2. Why Prompt Engineering is Important

- Improves accuracy of AI responses
- Reduces irrelevant or incorrect output
- Helps control tone, format, and depth
- Saves time and effort

3. Key Elements of a Good Prompt

- Clarity – Be clear and specific
- Context – Provide background information
- Task – Clearly define what you want
- Constraints – Mention limits (length, style, format)
- Examples – Add examples if needed

4. Types of Prompts

- Instruction-based prompts
- Question-based prompts
- Role-based prompts (e.g., 'Act as a teacher')
- Few-shot prompts (with examples)

5. Example Prompts

Weak Prompt: Explain machine learning.

Strong Prompt: Explain machine learning in simple terms for a beginner, using examples, in 150 words.

6. Common Mistakes

- Being too vague
- Giving multiple unclear tasks
- Not specifying output format

7. Tips for Beginners

- Start simple, then refine
- Use step-by-step instructions
- Ask for revisions if needed
- Experiment with different prompt styles